

Browne Jacobson

Complete firm and application research — opportunity & culture, health law & clinical negligence, sectors, degree apprenticeship structure, a day in the life, and personal application notes.

- Route:** Degree apprenticeship — Nottingham or Manchester
- Structure:** Paralegal (2 years) → progression to Solicitor Apprenticeship
- Featured route:** Health Advisory & Litigation (Health Law / Clinical Negligence)
- Diversity:** 43% of partners female; 36.9% first in their family to attend university

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1. Opportunity & Early Responsibility

Browne Jacobson runs future lawyer blogs, open to contributions from apprentices and trainees — a firm where new ideas are genuinely welcomed, and where staff can support the firm in creative ways beyond core casework (writing articles, contributing to newsletters, helping shape events). Every employee is given a chance to be involved and represented, whether through participating in events or writing an article.

Early responsibility on offer

- Reviewing case files
- Drafting documents and correspondence
- Case management responsibility
- Communicating with internal and external clients
- Potential for secondment
- Handling matters and running your own caseload under supervision

2. Culture

- Inclusive and supportive environment — everyone gets an opportunity to express their thoughts and opinions
- Positive, collaborative work environment with a lot of support from the whole team, especially for new starters
- An active social programme for trainees, plus away-days for all teams to connect outside the office
- Empowers every member of staff to be who they are at work, rather than needing to "fit a mould"
- Diversity stats: 43% of partners are female; 36.9% were the first in their family to attend university

Enabling people is one of the things Browne Jacobson is fantastic at. If you are willing, ambitious, and work hard, Browne Jacobson will give you a platform to achieve your aspirations.

— Firm/trainee account

3. Why Health Law & Clinical Negligence

Health law and clinical negligence work combines large-scale litigation, regulatory work and risk management with institutions like the NHS, while also managing reputational risk and working for the direct benefit of individuals. This sits at the intersection of institutional-scale work and personal, human impact.

- Clinical negligence connects to A-Level study of professional standards in tort (e.g. cases like *Re A* on necessity)
- Trust-building is central to this area of law — mirrored in extracurricular experience (leading tours, engaging at open evenings, customer service work) that has consistently produced meaningful, lasting professional connections

4. Why an Apprenticeship

An apprenticeship offers real challenge and early responsibility, which fuels personal development, knowledge and life experience more directly than years spent solely at university — while still recognising that becoming an apprentice is only the start of a much longer professional journey.

5. Degree Apprenticeship Structure

- Available at Nottingham or Manchester
- Starts as a Paralegal apprenticeship (2 years), with progression onto the Solicitor Apprenticeship
- Featured specialism: Health Advisory and Litigation (Health Law), including Clinical Negligence
- Support structure includes an induction programme, an Emerging Talent team, and a current-apprentice buddy

Common misconception addressed by the firm: apprentices do handle real matters and carry genuine responsibility — including running their own caseload under supervision.

6. Health & Care Sector

- Specialises in supporting healthcare organisations and professionals when things go wrong in medicine, or where there is disagreement about the care a patient should receive that needs resolving by the court
- Sits at the forefront of some of society's biggest issues, often featuring in the media, with tangible, visible results of the work involved
- Apprentices gain experience working with expert teams, leveraging senior colleagues' knowledge to learn faster and deliver strong client service

Mental Capacity & Court of Protection / Deprivation of Liberty

- An area with lots of recent legal change; the firm is described as the country's leading practice in this space
- Applies when someone lacks the mental capacity to consent to care, residence, or a medical procedure — a legal framework must be correctly followed for such arrangements to be lawful
- Follows the Supreme Court's *Cheshire West* judgment (March 2014), which significantly shifted how the law defines a person whose liberty has been deprived
- **Example case:** represented a local authority where a young man with autism and learning difficulties was being deprived of his liberty in supported living — the firm helped obtain a deprivation of liberty order from the court to authorise necessary but restrictive care arrangements

7. Commercial Sectors

COMPETITION	E-COMMERCE & CONSUMER	FRANCHISING	HEALTH-TECH	NHS	INSURANCE	PRIVATE CLIENT — WILLS & PROBATE	HOSPITALITY
SPORTS	FINANCE — PRIVATE EQUITY	ASSETS, FUNDS & INVESTMENT					

8. Retail — Fashion & Beauty

- Helps clients navigate regulatory and compliance issues, trading arrangements, brand protection, competition issues, property management, omni-channel offerings, data protection strategy, employment matters, reputation management, and business sale/purchase
- Recent years have significantly accelerated e-commerce growth and the need to commercialise data effectively — the high street's role has shifted toward interaction, experience and a frictionless customer journey
- Advertising technology, used well, gives real brand benefit and drives sales; the firm advises fashion/beauty brands on harnessing new tools this way
- Helps integrate compliant "buy now, pay later" options and marketplace/platform sales models
- Advertising team ensures packaging, above-the-line ads and creative content meet ASA requirements and avoid infringement risk
- Helps navigate an evolving regulatory landscape — e.g. plastic packaging taxes, ingredient reclassification, new consumer protections
- Award-winning corporate team with deep experience in M&A, private equity work, corporate governance and solvent reorganisations, working with UK and overseas clients and close relationships with leading firms globally
- Significant experience with early-stage businesses and scale-ups, including funding rounds and company documentation

9. Other Sectors

Beyond health and retail, the firm's sector reach also includes hospitality, sports, and finance (private equity; assets, funds and investment) — alongside continued strength in health-tech and traditional private client work (wills and probate).

10. Support Structure & Future Lawyer Blog

- Induction programme for new apprentices, supported by a dedicated Emerging Talent team
- Each apprentice is paired with a current-apprentice buddy
- The firm runs a Future Lawyer blog featuring contributions from apprentices and trainees
- Societies, events and the ability to suggest new initiatives/socials give apprentices a way to meet people across the firm; workload is described as manageable
- Apprentices are encouraged to ask as many questions as needed

11. A Day in the Life — Tips

- Understand that tasks might take longer while learning — attention to detail and patience matter
- Celebrate small wins along the way
- Speak up and ask for more time or clarification on expectations when needed
- Step back and fit in activities to unwind (e.g. the gym) alongside work

Example working day (Property Litigation team)

- Team discussion meeting covering clients, workload, and any close deadlines
- Meeting with a supervisor to update on work, discuss how things are going, and get feedback
- Informative team sessions to share experiences and resources
- A university study day or online course (e.g. tort law), with time still available for the gym
- Drafting urgent court proceedings
- Knowledge-sharing group sessions, exchanging experiences and tasks
- Legal research on current topics

- Prioritising and filing emails to stay on top of admin, using a diary/schedule system (e.g. Notion, spreadsheets)
- Monthly update meetings

12. Personal Fit Notes

Drafted talking points connecting personal motivations and experience to the firm's positioning — for use/refinement in application answers.

- A genuine desire to be an active contributor to firm culture, not just a learner — taking part in blogs, events and creative initiatives alongside core legal work
 - A consistent drive for curiosity, constant improvement, and saying "yes" to opportunities — demonstrated by taking on leadership roles (e.g. a marketing team) further than expected, and a constant pursuit of self-improvement academically
 - Interest in understanding how clients think, negotiate and decide — connecting a psychology-informed perspective to legal practice
 - Ability to form strong, trusting client relationships by adapting to different people and working collaboratively across teams
 - An interest in creative problem-solving — unique, novel solutions rather than only applying legal theory directly
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Sources: Browne Jacobson careers and sector pages; firm trainee/apprentice accounts; DEI report. Compiled as private research — verify current salary, deadline and programme details against the live listing before applying.